



THE PROSOPOGRAPHY OF THE NEO-ASSYRIAN EMPIRE

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Using the Electronic Data Base of the Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project
and with the Collaboration of Numerous Colleagues

edited by
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THE NEO-ASSYRIAN TEXT CORPUS PROJECT
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Sin-ahhē-eriba ("Sin has replaced the brothers"); Akk.; masc.; wr. ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU, ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU, ⁴30-PAB.MEŠ-SU, ^{md}30-PAB.ME-SU, ⁴30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU, ⁴30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU, ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, ⁴EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU, ^{md}EN.ZU-PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ-ŠEŠ-*eri-ba* (in a colophon: Borger [1973] 171, text A r ii "47" = Hunger [1968] no. 501), ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-KU₄ (in two colophons, STT 33: 127 = Hunger [1968], no. 351: 6 and STT 192 r 26' = Hunger [1968], no. 353: 3, playing with the close homophony between *erēbu* "to enter" and *eriba* "he replaced"), ⁴GAR?-PAB.MEŠ-SU²-*ba* (in a colophon: AAT 44 r 11' = Hunger [1968] no. 512: 4). Note also the following scribal errors in the writing of the name: ^{md}30-PAB-SU (BT 105 [Iraq 25, pl. 19] r. 2), ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ (Nassouhi [1927] 19, no. IX: 1), ^{md}30-PAB-SU (KAH 2 134: 6 [var. Ass. 13188]), ^{md}EN-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* (SAA 12 88:1), ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ-*eri-ba* (Borger [1956] Trb A:20), ⁴EN-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU (Tayl. ii 26 = 1R 38); ft. *snhrb* (2 Kgs. 19:20); [*sn*]*hrb* (Hug [1993] 19-21 AssB:16); *snhrjb* (2 Kgs. 18:13); *snhrjb* (Ahiqar); Σεν(ν)αχρηβ (LXX); Σαναχαριβος (Herodotus 2, 141); for other Greek forms of the name see Weißbach (1920) 2271; the many different writings of the name in later tradition which derive from the Hebrew and the Greek transcriptions are not collected here. See Tallqvist (1918) 196-8; Ungnad (1929) 191f (with an erroneous explanation of the name); Stamm (1939) 289f. Note that the Bible, by "Midrashic" name derivation, artificially links the name of Sennacherib to the Hebrew roots for "destroy" (*hrb*) and "shame" (*hrp*) (2 Kgs. 19:16-17, 24 = Isa. 37:17-18, 25); see Garsiel (1991) 46f. A document from Nineveh from about 670 BC seems to imply that giving the name of the former king Sin-ahhē-eriba to a commoner was considered a taboo and a sacrilege in Assyria (Kataja [1987]).

King of Assyria (705-681):

For a general picture see Olmstead (1923) 283-336; Luckenbill (1924) 9-19; von Soden (1954) 105-118; Labat (1967b) 68-76; Grayson (1991b)

103-22; Pečirková (1993) 1-10; Kuhrt (1995) 499-501; Mayer (1995) 342-380; Frahm (1997) 1-32.

I. Family background:

1. Sennacherib's parents and ancestors: Sennacherib was the son of Sargon II (Šarru-(u)kin), who was king of Assyria between 722 and 705 and of Babylonia between 710 and 705. Although, with one possible exception (Frahm [1997] 194-5 T.196), Sennacherib never mentions Sargon's name in his own inscriptions, the father-son relationship between the two kings is clear from Sennacherib's epithet *mār šarri rabû ša Šarru-kin* "great (crown) prince (lit.: eldest royal son) of Sargon" in the colophon of a text from the reign of Sargon (AAT 44 r 12' = Hunger [1968] 512:5). Furthermore, Sennacherib's successors Esarhaddon, Assurbanipal, Šamaš-šumu-ukin and Sin-šarru-iškun refer to their descent from both Sennacherib and Sargon; see, for example, Borger (1956) 6 Ass.B:15ff (Esarhaddon); Prism J "Stück 1":12f = Borger (1996) 194, 209 (Assurbanipal); RIMB 2 B.6.33.3:9ff (Šamaš-šumu-ukin) and KAH 1 56:4-5 (Sin-šarru-iškun); cf. also the references cited below sub V.3.a.-c. and V.4. Finally, in a text written in the name of Sennacherib though probably composed only after his death, the king announces that he is going to investigate the nature of a "sin" committed by "Sargon, my father" (SAA 3 33:10'). In his letters to Sargon written when he was crown prince (see below, II.2.) Sennacherib, in accordance with the formal address used in letters to the ruler, calls himself not "son" but "servant" of the king.

Sennacherib's mother may have been Atalia, Queen of Assyria and wife of Sargon II, whose names and titles are attested on objects from her tomb which was unearthed in the North-West Palace at Kalhu (Kamil [1999] 16 no. 5-7). If Atalia is the "mother of the king" mentioned in the debt note SAA 6 143, she was still alive in 692; she may have died between 683 and 681, the period when the transfer of property from the (recently deceased?) queen mother to the mother of the crown prince (probably Naqi'a), which is documented in a royal land grant, took place (SAA 12 21-23; see Melville [1999] 20f). Note, however, that Atalia cannot have been Sennacherib's mother if it is true, as appears from the anthropological examination of the bodies in the Nimrud sarcophagus Damerji [1999] 12), that she died when she was between thirty and thirty-five years of age. Sennacherib was born around 745, so his mother's birth should be dated to around 760 at the latest. In 722, when Sargon became king, she must have been nearly forty, and in 692, when the "mother of the king," according to the aforementioned debt note, was still alive, she would have been nearly seventy years old. The problem requires further study.

Sennacherib's paternal grandfather was Tiglath-pileser III, king of Assyria (745 to 727) and father of Sargon II (see Thomas [1993] for the two texts from which Sargon's descent from Tiglath-pileser can be inferred). His paternal grandmother may have been Iabâ, Queen of Assyria and wife of Tiglath-pileser III, whose names and titles are attested on objects from the same sarcophagus where

the grave goods of Atalia, Sennacherib's presumed mother, were found (Kamil [1999] 14 nos. 1-2; BaM 21 462:2).

As for Sennacherib's maternal grandparents (and his paternal grandmother Iabâ), it has recently been argued that they were members of the royal family of Judah (Dalley 1998). This idea is mainly founded on the fact that Sennacherib's alleged mother Atalia bore the same name as the famous daughter of Ahab and Jezebel who, in the 9th century BC, married into the Judean royal family and took over the reins of power (2 Kgs. 11:1-20; 2 Chr. 22:10-23:21); furthermore, the claim of the Judean king Ahaz to be a "servant" and a "son" of the Assyrian king Tiglath-pileser III (2 Kgs. 16:7) has been adduced as evidence for a family relationship between the Assyrian and the Judean royal house. The virtual identity between the name of Sennacherib's presumed mother and that of the earlier Judean queen is, however, insufficient to prove the former's descent from the Judean royal family — even though "Atalia" (also rendered as Ataliahu in the Bible) may in fact contain a short form of the divine name "Yahweh" (the first part of the name, *-atal-*, remains so far unexplained). As long as no clearer evidence for a connection with the Judean royal house is available, the origin of Sennacherib's mother cannot be established with certainty. The same holds true for the alleged Judean background of Sennacherib's paternal grandmother Iabâ, which is mainly based on the fact that she was buried in the same sarcophagus as Atalia. In the eyes of the present writer, there are no compelling reasons for the assumption that Sennacherib's policies towards Judah were influenced by particularly close relations with this country's ruling family.

In the Babylonian King List A iv 12' (Grayson [1980] 93), Sennacherib is said to belong to a "dynasty of Habigal" (BALA *ḫa-bi-gal*), an affiliation also given, in iv 16', for his son Aššur-nadin-šumi, while, in iv 14', Marduk-apla-iddina II appears as *šab* (ERIM) *ḫa-bi*. Sennacherib's uncle Shalmaneser V (Ululaiu), in iv 9', is linked to the "dynasty of Baltil" (i.e. Assur), and Sargon II, in iv 11', to no dynasty at all. The "dynasty of Habigal" is elsewhere unknown, and the implications of Sennacherib's alleged "dynastic" background must therefore remain unexplained (Dalley's idea about a Judean background of Sennacherib is too uncertain to justify speculations about the possibility that Habigal, possibly to be read Habi-rabû or even Habiru, assuming a scribal mistake, can somehow be linked to the "Hebrews").

2. Sennacherib's brothers and sisters: From the meaning of his name ("Sin has replaced the brothers"), it can be inferred that Sennacherib was not the first-born son of Sargon II; his elder brothers, however, had clearly all died by the time he was born. Sennacherib had several younger brothers (and sisters?), as can be seen from a letter, written to Sargon by Hunnî (SAA 1 133), which reports that the eldest prince (*mār šarri rabû*) Sennacherib and the other royal children (*mārē šarri gabbu*) were well. Some of his brothers survived Sennacherib; a letter from around 670 (ABL 1217 (+) CT

53 118, see Parpola [1983a] 239, 464) states that Esarhaddon was protected by them. The positions held by these men during Sennacherib's reign are unknown; a puzzling reference in Berossus to a brother of Sennacherib who ruled in Babylon is probably the result of corruption (see Burstein [1978] 23). While the names of Sennacherib's brothers are not attested, the name of one of his sisters is known: Ahat-abiša. She was married by Sargon to king Ambaris of Tabal/Bit Purutaš.

3. Sennacherib's wives and children:

a. His wives: Two wives of Sennacherib are known by name: Naqi'a and Tašmetu-šarrat. Naqi'a became famous because of the important position held by her during the reigns of her son Esarhaddon, Sennacherib's successor, and of her grandson Assurbanipal (see Melville [1999] for an account of her rôle and the sources pertaining to her). The relationship between Sennacherib and Tašmetu-šarrat seems to have had a particularly emotional tone: in an inscription on lion colossi flanking the entrance of Tašmetu-šarrat's private wing in the South-West Palace at Nineveh, which dates to around 695, Sennacherib praises her remarkable beauty and calls her "my beloved wife" (Borger [1988]; Frahm [1997] 121 T.36). From label inscriptions on two vessels from the Old Palace at Assur it appears that Tašmetu-šarrat also had a residential suite at Assur (KAH 1 50; Frahm [1997] 184). Borger has assumed, pointing to Sennacherib's enthusiasm for Tašmetu-šarrat's beautiful features, that she was a "late conquest" of the king, but as it cannot be excluded that she was a good-looking woman even after having reached her maturer years, the argument is not conclusive. It is not yet clear whether the two royal wives, Naqi'a and Tašmetu-šarrat, held the position of Assyrian queen simultaneously or successively, though the latter, with Tašmetu-šarrat preceding Naqi'a, is more probable. The problem of who was queen in Assyria under Sennacherib at a given time is complicated even further by a badly damaged inscription on a stele from Assur which might give the (so far undeciphered) name of (yet another?) wife(?) of Sennacherib (Andrae [1913] 9f no. 4; Frahm [1997] 184f).

b. His children: The names of at least seven children of Sennacherib are attested. His eldest son was Aššur-nadin-šumi who, in a Sennacherib inscription from Assur which records the donation of a house to him, is called GAL DUMU (OIP 2 152:3; Frahm [1997] 180 T.155). Aššur-nadin-šumi was installed as king in Babylon by Sennacherib in 700; in 694, he was handed over by the Babylonians to the Elamites and then presumably killed (see below, II.3.b.6', 10', and PNA 1/I 202).

Probably the second-eldest son of Sennacherib (not the youngest, as mistakenly stated in Frahm [1997] 4) was Aššur-ili-muballissu, who was also given a house in Assur. In the royal inscriptions commemorating this gift (OIP 2 151; Frahm [1997] 179f, T.151-154) the prince is called *māru tarden-nu* and is said to have been "begotten at the feet of Aššur." While the former qualification seems to indicate that Aššur-ili-muballissu was the king's second son (which is, however, uncertain — see

PNA 1/I 162f for a discussion of the term *tardenu*, the meaning of the latter statement might be that he was designated from birth for some important priestly office. Aššur-ili-muballissu is furthermore known as the recipient of a precious vase found at Nineveh (Walker [1980] 85; Frahm [1997] 149 T.115). It is probable that Aššur-nadin-šumi and Aššur-ili-muballissu received their houses sometime between 705 and 700.

At Nineveh Sennacherib prepared another house for a third son, Aššur-šumu-ušabši, whose place in the sequence of Sennacherib's children is unknown (CBI 181-183; VS 23 157 and duplicates, see Frahm [1997] 142f T.81-83; 180f T.156). Some of the bricks bearing the inscriptions documenting the construction of the house were found at Assur, which might imply that the prince had died before the building's completion so that the bricks could be used elsewhere.

Another son of Sennacherib who was younger than Aššur-nadin-šumi and — probably — also younger than Aššur-ili-muballissu, but older than Esarhaddon, was Urdu-Mullissu, who was to become the murderer of his father as expounded below sub II.3.b.16'. He is mentioned by name, and called a *mār šarri*, in a conveyance document from Nineveh dated to 694 (SAA 6 103). The document is part of a larger archive belonging to Aplaiā, the prince's "third man," from which the economic wealth of both the prince and his officer can be deduced (see SAA 6 xxxii).

Like Urdu-Mullissu, Nergal-šumu?-[...], yet another son of Sennacherib, also had servants at his disposal. In four documents dating to 694 and 693 respectively, a certain Sama' appears among the witnesses who is three times called "horse raiser of the son of the king (*mār šarri*)" (SAA 6 37, 39, 40) and once "horse raiser of Nergal-MU-[...]" (SAA 6 41). These references show that Nergal-MU-[...] must have been a son of Sennacherib and the commander of a — probably large — staff. Perhaps his name can be restored as Nergal-šumu-ibni; in SAA 6 186, a document dated to 683, an "information officer" of an individual bearing this name is mentioned as the contracting party (see SAA 6 xxxiif).

Kwasman and Parpola have, very tentatively, suggested (SAA 6 xli n. 59) that, as an alternative to reading the aforementioned name as Nergal-šumu-ibni, a restoration Nergal-šumu-[ušur] is possible, and, if correct, might entitle one to identify the prince with *sr'sr*, who according to the Bible was the other son of Sennacherib, besides *drmlk* (Urdu-Mullissu), who was involved in the fatal plot instigated against the king in 681 (2 Kgs. 19:37; Isa. 37:38). However, the Biblical name is clearly a hypocoristic form of an Akkadian name ending with -šarru-ušur and cannot therefore be linked with Nergal-MU-[...]. Though highly speculative, the hypothesis may be put forward that the Biblical *sr'sr* is to be identified with Nabû-šarru-ušur, governor of Marqasi and eponym of the year 682. There is no evidence so far that this man was a son of Sennacherib, but the possibility cannot be excluded.

As for the sons of Sennacherib dealt with in the preceding passages, it is not clear who was their

mother. It was probably either Tašmetu-šarrat or the woman(?) whose name (on the stele from Assur) has not yet been deciphered.

What we know for certain is that Sennacherib's son Esarhaddon was the child of Naqi'a who, because of her keen interest in Esarhaddon's promotion, can hardly have been the mother of Sennacherib's elder children. This is, in fact, explicitly stated in the oracle SAA 9 1.8, where Naqi'a is quoted as having implored the goddess Ištar of Arbail with the words: "You have placed the ones at the (king's) right and left side in your lap, but made my own offspring roam the steppe." The latter allusion clearly points to Esarhaddon's exile in 681. Esarhaddon's rôle as a younger brother is also acknowledged by himself: in Borger (1956) Nin. A i 8 he admits: "I was the younger brother of my elder brothers." Esarhaddon was made crown prince by Sennacherib in 683 and succeeded his father in 681 (see below II.3.b.16').

Sadditu, the only daughter of Sennacherib known so far by name, was most probably, like Esarhaddon, a child borne of Naqi'a. In a land sale document from the reign of Esarhaddon (SAA 6 251), she is called "daughter of Sennacherib and sister of Esarhaddon, king of Assyria." Whether she or another daughter of Sennacherib was married to Šusanqu (Susingu), an Egyptian called *ḫatna šarri* ("son-in-law [or: brother-in-law?] of the king") in a document from Nineveh dated to 692 (SAA 6 142), is all the more uncertain as it cannot be excluded that the Šusanqu in question was related by marriage, not to the Assyrian king, but to some Egyptian ruler (Onasch [1994] I 15f).

A small tablet from Nineveh (Borger [1988] 11; Frahm [1997] 212f T.176) which, on the obverse, contains "epigraphs" which probably served as labels to pictorial representations of Sennacherib's military campaigns, lists, on the reverse, a number of personal names. Both mythological heroes, like Gilgameš, Enkidu(?) and Humbaba, and ordinary human beings are referred to. Within the latter group, mention is made of Aššur-ili-muballissu, a name which is rare enough to justify the assumption that the individual in question can be identified with the son of Sennacherib referred to above. Another name in the list may be restored as either Aššur-n[adin-šumi] or Aššur-š[u]mu-ušabši. It is possible, though not at all certain, that other names in the list also refer to sons of Sennacherib; this might hold true for the names Ile'e-bullu-š[u] Aššur ("DINGIR'-*bul-lu*-[...]), Aššur-mukanniš-ilija, Ana-Aššur-t[aklak(?)], Aššur-GAG-EN-NA (i.e. Aššur-bani-beli?), Šamaš-andullašu (or: Šamaš-šalamšu), and Aššur-šakin-liti. The last name listed in the left column, Aššur-x-[...], might be restored as Aššur-a[hu-iddina], but this is mere conjecture. Possibly Sennacherib had his sons depicted, together with mythological heroes, on some relief or painting displayed in a palace at Nineveh.

II. The life of Sennacherib:

1. Sennacherib's birth and childhood: Since Aššur-nadin-šumi, the eldest son of Sennacherib, was old enough to become king of Babylon in 700 and therefore cannot have been born much later than 720, it seems reasonable to date Sennache-

rib's birth to about 745 (Parpola [1983a] 239 n. 390). His father Sargon being a son of Tiglath-pileser III (who was allegedly a son of Adad-nerari III), it can be assumed that Sennacherib was born, and spent his childhood, in the royal residence at Kalhu. Information about his early years is not available. What seems clear, however, is that Sennacherib did not receive the education of a prospective crown prince, since it was not his father Sargon but his uncle Shalmaneser who was the heir apparent to the throne and who became king after Tiglath-pileser's death. A certain Hunnī may have acted as a teacher and supervisor of Sennacherib; this may be inferred from Hunnī's letter (mentioned above, I.2.), which informs Sargon, then already king, about the well-being of Sennacherib and his brothers — a statement which seems to imply a rather intimate relationship between Hunnī and Sargon's children.

2. Sennacherib as crown prince: In 722, under circumstances which are shrouded in darkness, Sennacherib's father Sargon became king of Assyria. His predecessor — and (half-?)brother — Shalmaneser V, who had ascended the throne in 727, had died. The critical attitude shown by Sargon towards Shalmaneser in the so-called "Assur-Charter" (Saggs [1975]) indicates that the transfer of power was not smooth.

Presumably from the very beginning of his reign, Sargon conferred a number of important political responsibilities on his son Sennacherib, who was endowed with the title of "great (crown) prince" (see above, I.1.). Sennacherib was charged with both military and administrative tasks. Some insight into the problems Sennacherib had to handle during the reign of Sargon, and the "political socialisation" he underwent, can be gained from the letters Sennacherib wrote to his father in these years. Especially when Sargon was absent from Assyria, as, for example, during his stay in Babylonia in the years 710-707, Sennacherib seems to have taken over some of the most important royal duties. However, during such periods, he continually kept his father informed about matters of state which were of significance.

Several messages sent by Sennacherib to Sargon concern the situation in the rival kingdom of Urartu. In one case, Sennacherib reports that he had received news about treacherous activities of the ruler of Ukku who had informed the Urartian king about Assyrian attempts to fortify the city of Kumme; the Urartian king had thereupon made plans to capture the Assyrian officials present in Kumme, and Sennacherib is asked to send troops as soon as further information is available (SAA 1 29:8-21). Another ruler from the buffer region between Assyria and Urartu asks Sennacherib to force the Ukkean king not to threaten him any longer, and Sennacherib tells his father that he has sent a bodyguard to the obstinate Ukkean to hold him back (SAA 1 29 r. 11-17). Sennacherib kept the problems he had had with Ukku in mind and, in 697, conquered the city (see below sub II.3.b.7'). Other Urartian matters Sennacherib had to deal with were an Urartian attack on the land of Mannea (SAA 1 29:24-35), and the Urartian defeat

by the Cimmerians (SAA 1 30, 31:1-r. 25, and 32:8-16; see Fuchs [1994] 468f on the question of how this event is to be dated). A messenger of the Mannean (king) who had brought an audience gift and the regards of his lord was dressed (in purple) by Sennacherib (SAA 1 29 r. 18-21). In a letter written during Sargon's stay in Babylonia, Sennacherib asks his father whether he is to send the tribute brought by emissaries from Kummuhu (Commagene) to Babylon or receive it himself (SAA 1 33). Tribute and audience gifts are distributed by Sennacherib, according to another letter, to the Palace, the queen, himself (*mār šarri*), the grand vizier, the commander-in-chief, and several other high-ranking officials (SAA 1 34). An interesting reference to the land of Judah remains unclear due to the broken state of the passage in question (SAA 1 32 r. 9').

Sennacherib's letters also concern domestic affairs. Quarrels between officials(?) in Kalhu are dealt with (SAA 1 35), floods in the regions of Nineveh, Dur-Šarrukin, and Kurbail reported (SAA 1 36), and demands of the charioteers of the palace guard presented to Sargon (SAA 1 37). In a letter the attribution of which is not beyond doubt (see Watanabe [1991] 88), Sennacherib(?) informs the king about the work going on in Dur-Šarrukin (SAA 1 39), and in another letter he writes about trees for royal orchards (SAA 5 281), which is interesting given the fact that when Sennacherib became king himself he was very much committed to the laying out of parks and gardens (see below sub II.3.c.1'.1').

During the period in which he held the position of crown-prince, Sennacherib continued to reside, at least temporarily, in Kalhu: it was there that he received, according to one of his letters, the tribute of the Ashdodites (SAA 1 29 r. 22-24). However, he clearly also had a residence in Nineveh. This is suggested by Assurbanipal's statement that Sennacherib had dwelled, both as crown prince and as king, in the *bēt redūti* (Borger [1996] 16, 208, Prism A i 25f // F i 19f) which was situated on the site of Assurbanipal's later North Palace (still called *bēt redūti*) at Nineveh (Frahm [1997] 3). Emphasizing that parts of the state correspondence from the reign of Sargon were found in the debris of the North Palace, Parpola has suggested that the *bēt redūti* might have served as an administrative control centre when Sennacherib was crown prince (Parpola [1986] 232f), but it cannot be excluded that the letters in question were transferred to it only after Sargon's death. Grayson has assumed that the crown prince Sennacherib also had a residence in the city of Tarbiṣu a few kilometers to the north of Nineveh (Grayson [1991b] 140). However, while it is true that Assurbanipal, as crown prince, was given a palace in Tarbiṣu by his father Esarhaddon (Borger [1956] 71-3 Trb A-C), there is no clear indication that Sennacherib, too, resided there before his father's death (but it should be noted that the reconstruction of the temple of Nergal at Tarbiṣu was, as far as we know, the earliest building project which Sennacherib realised when he became king, see below II.3.c.3'). Whether Sennacherib moved to Khorsabad (Dur-Šarrukin)

with his father in 706 when the new residence built by Sargon was finally inaugurated is unknown. Reliefs from Sargon's new palace might portray Sennacherib as crown prince facing his father, king Sargon (e.g. Botta [1849] pl. 12).

3. Sennacherib as king:

a. The sources: The written sources pertinent to the history of Sennacherib's reign can be divided into two main groups: royal inscriptions on the one hand, and texts written from a non-royal perspective on the other.

Among Sennacherib's royal inscriptions, the most important class of texts providing historical information are those on clay cylinders and prisms which were written for, and mostly found at, Nineveh (quite a lot of duplicates, however, were also unearthed at Assur). These texts, frequently called "Annals," give detailed accounts both of the military campaigns of Sennacherib, generally narrated in chronological order, and of his building operations. Additional information on these subjects can be found in royal inscriptions on clay and stone tablets, bull and lion colossi, stelae, rock reliefs, stone blocks and smaller objects such as beads and bricks. Sennacherib's texts mostly come from Nineveh, Assur, and a few other places in Assyria. Only two short inscriptions were found in Babylonia. The well-preserved inscriptions available at that time were edited by Luckenbill (1924); for the edition of new texts, corrections to Luckenbill's work and an introduction to the corpus of Sennacherib's inscriptions, see Frahm (1997). Allusions to events from Sennacherib's reign can furthermore be found in the royal inscriptions of his successors Esarhaddon and Assurbanipal, and in inscriptions of the Neo-Babylonian king Nabonidus. Apart from giving detailed information on historical events, the royal inscriptions are the most important source for Sennacherib's royal titles and epithets, which underwent significant changes during his reign (see Liverani [1981] 231-51).

The non-royal sources which yield information about Sennacherib's reign belong to several different text categories. First, there are chronographic texts: king lists, eponym lists, and chronicles. Of particular value are the accounts given in the so-called "Babylonian Chronicle" and, for the beginning of Sennacherib's reign, in the Assyrian Eponym Chronicle. Several letters from Sennacherib's time are known, although their number is considerably smaller than the number of letters from the reigns of Sennacherib's predecessor Sargon and his successor Esarhaddon (see Dietrich [1967-68a] 95-100; Dietrich [1967-68] 192-206; Dietrich [1998]). The number of economic documents from the time of Sennacherib is comparatively large (see especially SAA 6 34-200). Those from Nineveh contain important information about leading officials serving under the king, and occasionally allow glimpses of historical events; furthermore, they make it possible, to a certain degree, to evaluate Assyria's economic situation under Sennacherib. There are a few letters written after Sennacherib's death which allude to events from his reign. Finally, some later texts written in Aramaic, Hebrew, and Greek can be regarded as sources which

provide, in spite of certain distortions, reliable historical information about the reign of Sennacherib; this holds for the story of Ahikar, the accounts of the Bible, Herodotus, Berossos, and possibly Menander. The "tertiary literature" from even later periods mainly gives narrative amplifications of the Biblical and classical accounts of Sennacherib's reign and can no longer be regarded as a source of historical value for a reconstruction of the age of Sennacherib.

Detailed references to the central text passages from which the history of Sennacherib's reign can be reconstructed are given below in connection with the episodes to which they refer; for an overview see Frahm (1997) 6f. The dates of the most important Sennacherib texts quoted are as follows: Tarbiṣu cylinders (Suleiman [n.d.]) — not dated, probably from 702; First Campaign (OIP 2 48-55, 94-8) — not dated, probably from 702; Bellino Cylinder (OIP 2 55-60, 94f, 99-101) — dated vii-702; Rassam Cylinder (Frahm [1997] 47-61) — dated ii-700; T.8 (Frahm [1997] 62-4) — dated 699; T.170 (Frahm [1997] 195-9) — not dated or date broken away, probably from 699; T.10 (Frahm [1997] 66-87) — i and iv-697; T.11 (Frahm [1997] 68-87) — viii-696 and v-695; Bull 2/3 (OIP 2 76-8) — not dated, probably from 694 and 694/3 respectively; Bull 4 (OIP 2 66-76, 117-25) — not dated, probably from 694 or 693 (see Russell [1999] 261-82 for the most recent treatment of these and other bull inscriptions of Sennacherib); Heidel/King (OIP 2 61-3, 103-116) — dated v-694; T.13 (Frahm [1997] 89-101) — date lost, probably from around 690; Chicago Oriental Institute Prism (OIP 2 23-47, 128-31) — dated iv-689 (the duplicate Taylor Prism dates to 20-xii-691, and the near-duplicate Jerusalem Prism possibly to xii.a-691, see Frahm [1997] 106, 112); Baltimore, Walters Art Gallery inscription (Grayson [1963] 83-96) — dated 25-viii-690; Nebi-Yunus inscription (OIP 2 85-9, 131-4) — not dated, probably from around 690; Ungnad/Winckler (Frahm [1997] 129-36) — not dated or date lost, probably from around 690/689; Bavarian (OIP 2 78-85) — not dated, probably from around 688; Bit-Akitu — not dated, probably from around 685.

Though historically important, the visual sources from Sennacherib's reign, especially the reliefs from the South-West Palace (see Russell [1991] for an overview), are not systematically taken into consideration in this article. Only those which bear epigraphs are referred to systematically.

b. The political and military events of Sennacherib's reign:

1'. Sennacherib's accession to the throne: According to the Eponym Chronicle B6 r. 11 (Millard [1994] 48), Sennacherib ascended the Assyrian throne on the 12th day of Abu (v.) 705. In the so-called "double datings" found in some colophons from Sennacherib's reign, there are a few inconsistencies with regard to the fixing of Sennacherib's first regnal year (705, 704 or even 703; see Millard [1994] 71). They are probably due to the fact that dating after regnal years was a Babylonian usage to which the Assyrians were not accustomed.

Although the new king, then about forty years old, seems to have come to power without meeting any resistance from other pretenders to the throne, the circumstances of his accession were not particularly favourable. Normally, it would have been Sennacherib's duty to bury his deceased predecessor in the city of Assur. However, as his father Sargon had been killed on the battlefield in far-off Tabal and his body had not been recovered by the Assyrians (Bab. Chronicle ii 4' = Grayson [1975] 76; Eponym Chronicle B6 r. 8-10 = Millard [1994] 48), the funeral of the deceased king as prescribed by tradition could not take place. This was clearly regarded as highly inauspicious. A later text probably written under Esarhaddon reports that Sennacherib tried to investigate the nature of an alleged "sin" of Sargon which was considered to have been the cause of his unhappy end (SAA 3 33), and there are reasons to suspect that the famous Assyrian scholar Nabû-zuqup-kenu studied the passage about spirits of the dead in the 12th tablet of the Gilgameš epic in order to elucidate the consequences of Sargon's end. The transfer of the royal court to Nineveh, realised immediately after Sennacherib had become king, was perhaps motivated at least partly by the fear that Sargon's ghost might still be present at Dur-Šarrukīn. Sennacherib's work on the temple of Nergal, the war and underworld god, at Tarbišu (see below, II.3.c.3') may have been inspired by his father's fate (see Frahm [1999]).

2. The campaign against the Kulummeans in 704: Sargon had been defeated and killed in 705 by a "Kulummean" named Gurdī (Eponym Chronicle B6 r. 9 = Millard [1994] 48). The same Eponym Chronicle reports (r. 15) that in 704, certainly in order to take revenge for the killing of Sargon, the Assyrian "magnates" went on a campaign against the "Kulummeans" (see Frahm [1999] 83f). Due to the broken state of the Chronicle, the result of this campaign, in which the king clearly did not participate, is unknown; however, it seems probable that the operation was not a great success, as it is not mentioned at all in Sennacherib's inscriptions. Another campaign against an Anatolian ruler called Gurdī (who is probably to be identified with Sargon's opponent) took place in 695, see below sub II.3.b.9'.

3'. The campaign against Babylonia in the years 704-702(?) (see Frahm [1997] 9f): From the beginning of Sennacherib's reign, the political situation in Babylonia was highly unstable. While the Babylonian King List A, after mentioning Sargon's rule over Babylonia, attributes a reign of two years to Sennacherib (Grayson [1980] 93 iv 12'), the "Ptolemaic Canon" describes the same period as "kingless" (Grayson [1980] 101), and a document from Nippur dated posthumously to the 19th year of Sargon (Brinkman - Kennedy [1983] 13) shows that there was in fact some confusion about who was king in Babylonia in the period in question. When, probably at the beginning of 704 (or 703, as proposed by Brinkman), after a one month reign of Marduk-zakir-šumi II, the kingship over Babylonia was usurped by the well-known Assyrian arch-enemy Marduk-apla-iddina II (the Biblical Mero-

dach-baladan), a Chaldean of the Bit Iakin tribe (see King List A iv 13'f = Grayson [1980] 93 and, for Berossos, Burstein [1978] 23), Sennacherib decided that it was time to wage war against Babylonia. The campaign is mentioned in the Assyrian Eponym Chronicle B6 r. 13 (Millard [1994] 49, the badly broken entry is dated to 704), and in the Babylonian Chronicle ii 9-25 (Grayson [1975] 76f). It is described in detail, and with some variation, in several inscriptions of Sennacherib which label it as the king's "first campaign" (Tarbišu cylinders:5-61 = Suleiman [n.d.] 138-66; First Campaign:5-62 = OIP 2 48-55; Bellino:5-19 = OIP 2 55-60; Rassam:5-17 = Frahm [1997] 51f, 57f; Bull 2/3:7-10, 13-15 = OIP 2 76f; Bull 4:3-9 = OIP 2 66f; Chicago i 20-64 = OIP 2 24-6; Nebi-Yunus:6-8, 12 = OIP 2 85f). Furthermore, an astrological report from Assur dated to the second year of Sennacherib and dealing with omens regarding Elam and Babylonia may be related to the campaign (the text is to be published by J. Fincke). The campaign started with the departure of the king and his troops from Assur. Sennacherib first conquered the city of Cutha and then came to the aid of an Assyrian contingent which was attacked by Marduk-apla-iddina and his Aramean, Elamite, and Arabian allies at Kish. He defeated the enemy troops and put Marduk-apla-iddina to flight. After plundering the royal palace at Babylon, Sennacherib pursued the fugitive, but in vain. However, a great number of southern Mesopotamian tribes and cities which had supported the notorious Chaldean were vanquished in the following months, and mass deportations took place. In Babylon, Sennacherib installed Bel-ibni, a local aristocrat, as a puppet king. When passing the border region between Babylonia and Assyria on his return home, Sennacherib destroyed the city of Hirimmu and received the tribute of the city of Hararatu.

4'. The campaign against the Zagros region in 702 (see Frahm [1997] 10): Assyrian rule had been loosened not only in the south, but also in the east; so the king's so-called "second campaign," known from Sennacherib's inscriptions (Bellino:20-33 = OIP 2 58-60; Rassam:18-31 = Frahm [1997] 52f, 58; Bull 2/3:15f = OIP 2 77; Bull 4:9-17 = OIP 2 67f; Chicago i 65-ii 36 = OIP 2 26-9; Nebi-Yunus:12f = OIP 2 86; K 1280:1-10 = OIP 2 156; Jerwan no. 34(+) = Frahm [1997] 157), was directed against the Zagros region. First, the insubordinate Kassites and Iasubigalleans from the mountainous territory east of Namri were caught and settled in cities placed under the authority of the governor of Arrapha. Then the king moved on to Ellipi whose king A/İšpabara, a former Assyrian vassal who had become a rebel, fled. Parts of his country were annexed and added to the Assyrian province of Harhar.

5'. The campaign against Judah and the west in 701: Certainly the best known and most discussed military operation undertaken by Sennacherib is his campaign against the west with its famous attack on Jerusalem, which is also recorded in the Bible. There are still many open questions regarding this campaign, labelled by Sennacherib as his third. A thoughtful evaluation of the evidence

which takes into account the vast earlier literature on the subject is given by Gallagher (1999). The most important sources for the campaign are, first, Sennacherib's own inscriptions (Rassam:32-58 = Frahm [1997] 53-5, 58f; Bull 2/3:17-22 = OIP 2 77; Bull 4:18-32 = OIP 2 68-70; Chicago ii 37-iii 49 = OIP 2 29-34; Nebi-Yunus:13-15 = OIP 2 86), to which a number of reliefs from the South-West Palace at Nineveh, among them those which illustrate the capture of the Judean city of Lachish, can be added (Russell [1991] 160-4; Russell [1999] 287-91), and second, the Biblical texts referring to the campaign (2 Kgs. 18:13-19:36; Isa. 36:1-37:37; 2 Chr. 32:1-23). Furthermore, Herodotus gives an account of it in Hist. II 141, and Josephus, quoting Menander, offers material which may equally have some bearing on the reconstruction of the operation (Jos. Ant. IX 284, see Lulfi). Whether a fragmentary inscription regarding an Assyrian attack against a Judean king, presumably Hezekiah (Na'aman [1974]), also refers to Sennacherib's "third campaign" is subject to doubt (see Frahm [1997] 229-32). Noting the important differences between Sennacherib's account of his third campaign, the relief program at Nineveh, and the Biblical reports, several scholars have suggested that Sennacherib undertook a second campaign against Judah after 689, but there is so far no conclusive evidence for this idea. Sennacherib's inscriptions seem to imply that the campaign of 701 was a reaction to the withholding of the annual tribute imposed by the Assyrians on several Phoenician and Palestinian cities. Sennacherib first marched against Phoenicia; he put Tuba'lu on the throne of Sidon instead of its former king Lulfi who fled to Cyprus, and received the tribute of numerous cities and countries. The Assyrian king then marched southwards. The citizens of Ekron, who had handed over their king Padfi, a supporter of the Assyrians, to Hezekiah (Hazaqi-Iau) of Judah, called on Egypt and Nubia for aid, but the coalition was defeated by Sennacherib at Eltheke. The Assyrian attack on the land of Judah is the last episode of the campaign described in Sennacherib's inscriptions. Forty-six Judean cities were conquered and Jerusalem was placed under siege. Though failing to take the city, the Assyrians forced Hezekiah to release Padfi, who was reinstalled at Ekron, and to pay a heavy tribute to the Assyrian king.

6'. The campaign against Babylonia in 700 (see Frahm [1997] 11): Sennacherib's so-called fourth campaign was again directed against Babylonia, where the rule of Bel-ibni had remained unstable, mainly because of the ongoing activities of Marduk-apla-iddina and another Chaldean, Mušezib-Marduk (see Dietrich [1998]; Liverani [1981] 252-7). The campaign, besides being described in Sennacherib's inscriptions (K 2627+ r. 23 and DT 320:1'-7' = Frahm [1997] 199-201 T.171; Bull 2/3:11-13 = OIP 2 76f; Bull 4:33-7 = OIP 2 71; Chicago iii 50-74 = OIP 2 34f; Nebi-Yunus:8-12 = OIP 2 85f), is also reflected in non-royal sources: the Babylonian Chronicle (Grayson [1975] 77 ii 26-31), some king lists (Grayson [1980] 93:16; 101; 120:12; 122:1), and Berossos (Burstein [1978] 23). The rebel territories of southern Meso-

potamia were devastated, and Marduk-apla-iddina and Mušezib-Marduk put to flight to Elam. Sennacherib installed his eldest son, Aššur-nadin-šumi, on the Babylonian throne, an arrangement which ensured Assyrian control over Babylonia for the next six years.

7'. The campaign against mount Nipur and Ukku in 697 (see Frahm [1997] 13): Sennacherib's inscriptions (Judi-Dagh:12-51 = OIP 2 64-6; Bulls 2/3:22-3 = OIP 2 77; Bull 4:37-47 = OIP 2 71f; Chicago iii 75-iv 31 = OIP 2 35-8; Nebi-Yunus:16f = OIP 2 86) and a relief from Nineveh (Frahm [1997] 124f T.39) are the sources for a campaign against regions in the north of Assyria which took place in 697 and culminated, after the destruction of several cities situated on Mount Nipur, in the conquest of the city of Ukku in the border region between Assyria and Urartu. Because of its notoriously pro-Urartian politics, this city had been a factor of concern for Sennacherib already when he was still crown prince (see above, II.2).

8'. The campaign against Cilicia in 696 (see Lanfranchi [2000] 22-31): An Assyrian campaign against Cilicia which took place in the absence of the king is the subject of several inscriptions of Sennacherib (Heidel iv 92-v 28 = Borger [1979] 80; Bulls 2/3:24 = OIP 2 77; Nebi-Yunus:17f = OIP 2 86). According to these texts an Assyrian official, Kirua, who was supported by the cities of Anchiale and Tarsus, had rebelled in Illubru, and had blocked roads. He was caught by the Assyrian troops and later flayed in Nineveh, while deportees were settled in Illubru. The campaign is also described by Berossos of whose report two different versions, one handed down by Alexander Polyhistor, the other by Abydenus, have survived (Burstein [1978] 24). According to Berossos, it was accompanied by a military confrontation between Assyrians and Greeks which, according to the first-mentioned source, took place on the land, while the second source speaks of a sea-battle. That these stories reflect some historical reality is all the more probable as both the Greek sources and Sennacherib's inscriptions mention the erection of an inscribed monument by the Assyrian king on the occasion of the campaign.

9'. The campaign against Til-Garimmu in 695 (see Frahm [1997] 14; Lanfranchi [2000] 23f): One year after the operation against Cilicia, the Assyrian army went a second time to Anatolia, again without being accompanied by the king. The campaign, mentioned in several royal inscriptions (Heidel v 29-43 = Borger [1979] 80; Bull 2/3:24f = OIP 2 77; Nebi-Yunus:19 = OIP 2 86), was directed against Til-Garimmu, a town situated at the border of Tabal, where a certain Gurdî, who is called "king of a vassal city," had rebelled. As the name (Til-)Garimmu may be another spelling of Kulummû (see Frahm [1999] 76f n. 12, Lanfranchi [2000] 24 n. 68), it is quite probable that the Gurdî in question is to be identified with Gurdî the Kulummian who, in 705, had defeated and killed Sennacherib's father Sargon (see above II.3.b.1'). The city of Til-Garimmu was conquered and destroyed, and its people were deported. Gurdî, however, as in 704 (see above II.3.b.2'), seems to have

escaped, for there is no hint in Sennacherib's inscriptions that he was captured.

10'. The maritime expedition against Elam in 694 and the subsequent military clashes in Babylonia up to 693 (see Frahm [1997] 14f): Sennacherib's "sixth campaign," undertaken in 694 and directed against Elamite territory, led to a fatal political chain-reaction with severe fighting in Babylonia which continued in 693 (and had further repercussions). The events are reported in Sennacherib's inscriptions (Bull 4:48-102 = OIP 2 73-6; Bull 2/3:25-32 = OIP 2 77f; Baltimore:16-19 = Grayson [1963] 88-91; Chicago iv 32-53 = OIP 2 38f; Nebi-Yunus:19-36 = OIP 2 86-8; Ungnad/Winckler:1'-15' = Frahm [1997] 130-2), and in non-royal sources: the Babylonian Chronicle (Grayson [1975] ii 36-iii 9), the Šamaš-šumu-ukin Chronicle (Grayson [1975] 128:1), some king lists (Grayson [1980] 93:17; 101; 120:7-9; 122:2), and a letter (BM 135586 r. 26-30 = Parpola [1972] 22f). The campaign started as a kind of aquatic adventure. Sennacherib had ships made and transported to the mouth of the Euphrates whence they embarked for the Elamite coast. Some cities there were destroyed, and Chaldeans who had fled to the region in 700 were deported. The Elamite king Hallušu, provoked by the attack, reacted immediately by sending troops to Babylonia. He conquered Sippar, and was handed over Sennacherib's son Aššur-nadin-šumi, the Babylonian king, by the citizens of Babylon. Aššur-nadin-šumi, who was probably killed in Elam, was followed by Nergal-ušešib of the Gahul family, an enemy of Assyria who, during the months which followed, was involved in heavy fighting with Sennacherib's troops. The Assyrians eventually gained the upper hand. On 7th Tašritu (vii.) 693 Nergal-ušešib was taken prisoner on the battlefield near Nippur and transported to Assyria.

11'. The campaign against Elam in 693 (see Frahm [1997] 15f): The events of the second half of 693 are described again both in Sennacherib's inscriptions (Baltimore:19-44 = Grayson [1963] 90f; Chicago iv 54-v 16 = OIP 2 39-41; Nebi-Yunus:36-44 = OIP 2 88; Ungnad/Winckler:16'-29' = Frahm [1997] 130-2) and in other sources: the Babylonian Chronicle (Grayson [1975] 79 iii 9-12), some king-lists (Grayson [1980] 93:18; 101; 120:7-9; 122:3), and an Assurbanipal text (Prism A iv 123-7 = Borger [1996] 46, 237f). Immediately after the defeat of Nergal-ušešib, the Elamite king Hallušu was killed and succeeded by Kutur-Nahhunte. Sennacherib tried to benefit from the unrest in Elam by invading the country, an operation labelled by him as his "seventh campaign." He conquered several cities in the Elamite border region and was on the way to the royal city of Madaktu when suddenly the winter set in, forcing him to return to Nineveh. In the meantime the Chaldean Mušešib-Marduk, one of Sennacherib's main opponents in 700 (see above, II.3.b.6'), became king in Babylon.

12'. The battle of Halulê in 691 (see Frahm [1997] 16): The ever-growing tensions between Assyria and Babylonia eventually escalated into a fierce battle which took place in 691. Mušešib-

Marduk, the Babylonian king, had been able to assemble a coalition of Babylonian, Chaldean, Aramean, Elamite, and Persian troops which confronted the Assyrian army at the city of Halulê somewhere near Samarra. According to Sennacherib's inscriptions (Baltimore:11-16, 45-115 = Grayson [1963] 88-95; Chicago v 17-vi 35 = OIP 2 41-7; Nebi-Yunus:44-55 = OIP 2 88f; 89-4-26, 150 i 3'-8' (+?) K 2655 i' 1-19' = Frahm [1997] 203-5 T.173; K 2622 (+):1-11' = Frahm [1997] 207f T.174; Ungnad/Winckler:29'-52' = Frahm [1997] 131-3) which describe the battle, the climax of the king's "eighth campaign," in a highly poetic style, the Assyrians were able to defeat their opponents and put to flight the Elamite and Babylonian leaders of the enemy coalition. The Babylonian Chronicle, on the other hand (Grayson [1975] 80 iii 16-18), reports that the Assyrians suffered a set-back at Halulê. It is clear, however, that if there was a set-back, it did not have a lasting effect, since already in 690 Assyrian troops had started to lay siege to Babylon.

13'. The campaign against the Arabs in 690 (see Frahm [1997] 16, 135): Presumably in order to prevent the Arabs from supporting the Babylonian king as they had in 704 (see above, II.3.b.3'), in 690 Sennacherib launched a campaign against the Arab queen and priestess Te'elhunu and a certain Haza-il who is called, in later texts, king of the Arabs. According to an inscription of Sennacherib (Ungnad/Winckler:53'-9' = Frahm [1997] 131-3) and several texts of his successors Esarhaddon and Assurbanipal (Nin.A iv 1-5, 15 and duplicates = Borger [1956] 53f; K 3087:2-19 and duplicates = Borger [1996] 69f), thousands of camels were carried off, the city of Adummatu (Dumat al-Jandal in the Wadi Sirhan) was captured, and Te'elhunu, who had tried in vain to escape the Assyrians by fleeing to the desert city of Kapanu (modern Kaf), was brought to Assyria. Precious stones which were plundered at Adummatu, as can be inferred from the cuneiform inscriptions they bear, have been found at Nineveh (Frahm [2000a] 86-9).

14'. The destruction of Babylon in 689 (see Frahm [1997] 16f): After a siege which took more than one year, Babylon was eventually captured by Assyrian troops on 1st Kislimu (ix.) 689. The ensuing total destruction of the city is described in two Sennacherib inscriptions (Bavian:43-54 = OIP 2 83f; Bit-Akitu:36-47 = OIP 2 137f), and is reflected in the Babylonian Chronicle (Grayson [1975] 80f iii 19-24), in the Esarhaddon Chronicle (Grayson [1975] 127:31-3), and in some king lists (Grayson [1980] 93:19; 101; 122:4). The annihilation of Babylon, the most famous religious and an important political centre of Mesopotamia, was a drastic measure which had far-reaching consequences for the future relationship between Babylonia and Assyria. It formed the political background to Sennacherib's religious reform, which consisted in a transfer of Marduk mythology to the god Aššur and the creation of new cultic installations at Assur (see below II.3.c.2'.a'.-b'.) modelled after, and intended to replace, the cultic topography of Babylon (Frahm [1997] 282-8).

15'. Assyrian foreign politics after 689 (see Frahm [1997] 16-18): There are very few texts, and in particular hardly any Sennacherib inscriptions, which inform us about Assyrian foreign politics between 689 and 681. Probably these years were a period of relative peace, though it might be more appropriate, especially with regard to Babylonia, to speak of a peace of the graveyard. Delegations from far-away countries came to visit Sennacherib, as for example a Sabeian embassy which brought spices and precious stones to Assyria (Bit-Akitu:48-51 = OIP 2 138); a few of these stones, inscribed with short cuneiform texts, have been found at Nineveh (Frahm [2000a] 84-6). Some unrest seems to have continued in southern Mesopotamia where Sennacherib, according to inscriptions of Esarhaddon (Nin.A ii 40-2 = Borger [1956] 46; for other sources see Frahm [2000a] 90 n. 63), established Nabû-zer-kitti-lišir, a son of Marduk-apla-iddina, as governor of the Sealand. Nabû-zer-kitti-lišir's dependency on the Assyrian king is apparent from yet another precious stone from Nineveh which represents, according to its inscription, an audience gift of the Sealand ruler (Frahm [2000a] 89-91).

16'. The succession arrangement and the murder of Sennacherib in 681 (see Frahm [1997] 18f): While no major foreign threats endangered the Assyrian hegemony, in the years after 689 the domestic situation became more and more unstable. The reason for this was an increasingly severe struggle for the succession which divided the princes at Sennacherib's court. Who exactly was Sennacherib's first crown prince is not completely clear. It may have been the king's eldest son, Aššur-nadin-šumi (so Porter [1993] 14), provided that his rule in Babylon was intended to be merely a temporary stage in his career. This, however, seems doubtful. More probable is the proposal of Parpola and Kwasman (SAA 6 xxvii-xxxiv) that Sennacherib's first Assyrian crown prince was Urdu-Mullissu. Though the suggested date of his appointment, 698, based on the idea that *mār šarri* is to be interpreted in every instance as "crown prince," remains uncertain, it seems clear that Urdu-Mullissu, whether formally introduced into the office of the crown prince or not, did at least expect to become Sennacherib's successor (see Melville [1999] 19-22). It was certainly a shock for him when, in 683 or slightly earlier, a younger son, Esarhaddon, a child of Sennacherib's wife Naqi'a, was formally designated crown prince by the king and introduced into the *bēt redūti*. The Assyrian population, and also the members of the royal family, including Urdu-Mullissu, had to swear a loyalty oath in favour of the new crown prince which, in its written form, is known to us in the form of three fragments from Assur (SAA 2 3 and two other small pieces to be published by the author) and which is mentioned in Esarhaddon's inscriptions (Nin.A i 8-22 = Borger [1956] 40f). The oath, however, did not prevent Sennacherib's older sons from conspiring against Esarhaddon and eventually forcing him to go into exile. The situation at the Assyrian court now became highly critical. Sennacherib refrained from changing the

succession arrangement again. Esarhaddon's claim that he remained, in spite of his flight from Assyria, the designated successor (Nin.A i 23-40 = Borger [1956] 41f) seems to be correct. On 20th Tebetu (x.) 681 Sennacherib, as a consequence of his stubbornness, was killed by Urdu-Mullissu and his accomplices, who may have stabbed him to death between the bull colossi of a temple at Nineveh. The event had a deep and lasting impact on the people of the ancient Near East and is recorded in numerous sources: Esarhaddon's inscriptions which, however, remain very vague with regard to the killing (Nin.A i 41-52 = Borger [1956] 42f), an Assyrian letter from which the name of the murderer, Urdu-Mullissu, can be inferred (Parpola [1980]), Assurbanipal texts which record the place of the killing (Prism A iv 70-3 = Borger [1996] 44; SAA 3 44:24), an inscription of Nabonidus which links Sennacherib's murder with his actions against Babylon (Nab.8 i 1-41 = VAB 4 270-3), the Babylonian Chronicle which furnishes the date of the event (Grayson [1975] 81 iii 34-7), the Biblical accounts which link Sennacherib's violent death, allegedly accomplished in the temple of *nsrk* (i.e. Nisku or Ninurta?), with his campaign against Judah and mention a certain *sr'sr* (see above I.3.b.) as another son of the king involved in the plot (2 Kgs. 19:37; Isa. 37:38; 2 Chr. 32:31, cf. Jos. Ant. X 23), and Berossos, who gives a distorted form of Urdu-Mullissu's name (Burstein [1978] 25). Note that the Biblical statement according to which Sennacherib was killed with a sword (*b-hrb*) might be a pun on the king's name (Garsiel [1991] 47) and that its historical reliability is therefore doubtful. The murderers did not profit from their deed for very long. On 8th Addaru (xii.) 681 Esarhaddon, as can be inferred from his own inscriptions (Nin.A i 53-ii 11 = Borger [1956] 43-5) and the Babylonian Chronicle (Grayson [1975] 82 iii 38), entered Nineveh, chased the plotters away, and ascended the Assyrian throne.

c. Sennacherib's building projects: Compared to Sennacherib, there is no other Mesopotamian king who left such a vast amount of inscriptions regarding building activities, and no-one else describes their technical details with such care. Sennacherib was a passionate builder who boasts of having personally introduced a number of metallurgical and horticultural innovations (see Frahm [1997] 277f for details). The following survey of Sennacherib's building projects is necessarily concise; for a more detailed overview see Frahm (1997) 267-76.

1'. Building projects in Nineveh:

a'. The South-West Palace on Kuyunjik: Detailed descriptions of Sennacherib's most ambitious building project, the South-West Palace and its surrounding parks, can be found in the following texts which date to the period between 702 and 689: First Campaign:68-92 = OIP 2 95-8; Bellino:39-57 = OIP 2 99-101; Rassam:66-85 = Frahm (1997) 55-61; building inscription T.10/11:14-274 = Frahm (1997) 72-83; King v 38-viii 76 = OIP 2 103-16; Bull 4 sl. 3:21-sl. 4:42, see OIP 2 117-25 (var.); ICC 38-42, bull no. 1:6-bull no. 2:52 = OIP 2 117-25 (for other bull inscriptions with relevant

- passages see Russell [1999] 261-82); Lion inscription, lion no. 1:1'-lion no. 2:34' = Borger (1988) 9f (mentioning a special wing for the royal wife Tašmetu-šarrat); Chicago vi 36-8 = OIP 2 128; for short brick and stone inscriptions see Frahm (1997) 139-41 T.65-74; cf. furthermore T.13 vi 1'-21', vii 1-13 = Frahm (1997) 91-4; see also Eponym Chronicle B7 r. 5'-8' = Millard (1994) 49. For an exhaustive treatment of the South-West Palace project which takes into account the rich archaeological remains see Russell (1991).
- b'. A bridge opposite the gate of the "inner city": Rassam:90 = Frahm (1997) 57, 60f; T.8:16' = Frahm (1997) 63f; building inscription T.10/11:213-16 = Frahm (1997) 78, 83; T.170 (K 2662) r. 9f = Frahm (1997) 198f.
- c'. The citadel wall of Kuyunjik: T.170 (K 2662) r. 9'-22' = Frahm (1997) 198f.
- d'. The temple of Sin, Ningal, Šamaš, and Aja, and the temple of Ištar on Kuyunjik: AAA 18 no. 16 r. 4'-14' = Frahm (1998b) 109f; cf. also Bellino:44 = OIP 2 99; Rassam:71, 77f = Frahm (1997) 56, 60; building inscription T.10/11:32-4, 66-9 = Frahm (1997) 73, 81.
- e'. Other temples: Two fragmentary Sennacherib inscriptions from Nineveh mention construction works(?) at the temple of Haja, god of the scribes (K 1635:10-19 = OIP 2 147; A 16931:2'-5' = Frahm [1997] 110). Whether this sanctuary was related to the Nabû temple at Nineveh or possibly situated at Assur is unclear. Even more uncertain is the assumption, based on a broken line in another fragmentary royal inscription (K 1634 ii' 17' = Frahm [1997] 106), that Sennacherib built a temple for the warlike Sebetti gods at Nineveh.
- f'. The wall of Nineveh: Sennacherib enlarged Nineveh and built a huge wall around the city which comprised, in its final state, eighteen monumental gates. Inscriptions dating from 699 to 690 commemorate this most ambitious project: T.8:9'-13' = Frahm (1997) 62-4; building inscription T.10/11:150-204 = Frahm (1997) 76-8, 82; T.13 vii 1'-48' = Frahm (1997) 92f, 94f; Royal road stelae:16-19 = OIP 2 153; for short brick and stone inscriptions see Frahm (1997) 141f T.75-80a.
- g'. The royal road at Nineveh: T.13 vii 50'-52' = Frahm (1997) 93, 95; Royal road stelae:19-27 = OIP 2 153.
- h'. Other roads and public squares: First Campaign:91 = OIP 2 98; Bellino:61 = OIP 2 101; Rassam:89 = Frahm (1997) 57, 60; T.170 (K 2662) r. i' 6'-8' = Frahm (1997) 198f; building inscription T.10/11:204-6 = Frahm (1997) 78, 82; King viii 13f = OIP 2 113; cf. T.13 vii 49f = Frahm (1997) 93, 95.
- i'. A palace combined with an armoury situated on Nebi Yunus (the construction of this building can be dated to around 690): Chicago vi 39-73 = OIP 2 128-30; Nebi-Yunus:55-94 = OIP 2 131-4; Ungnad/Winckler:10'-15" = Frahm (1997) 132f; T.178:4-17 = Frahm (1997) 214; horse trough inscription: MacGinnis (1989) 189.
- j'. A house for the prince Aššur-šumu-ušabši: CBI nos. 181-3; VS 23 157 and duplicates; see Frahm (1997) 142f T.81-83; 180f T.156.
- k'. An Akitu house at Nineveh: According to a fragmentary inscription found at the Nergal Gate at Nineveh and dated to 690 (Ahmad - Grayson [1999]), Sennacherib built an Akitu house, presumably for Aššur and Ištar (the divine names are not preserved), which may have been situated in a park outside the city wall; see Frahm (2000) for some comments on this project.
- l'. Parks, gardens and fields in the environs of Nineveh, and canals constructed for their irrigation: Sennacherib tried to enlarge the yearly harvest in the Nineveh region by implementing a number of huge cultivation and irrigation projects. The water needed for Nineveh was directed to the city from far away, necessitating the construction of large aqueducts like the famous one at Jerwan. The canalheads were sometimes, for example at Chinnis/Bavian, sumptuously supplied with sculptures: First Campaign:88-90 = OIP 2 97f; Bellino:58-60 = OIP 2 101; Rassam:86-8 = Frahm (1997) 57, 60; T.8:1'-6', 15' = Frahm (1997) 62-4; T.170 (K 3752) r. ii' 20-36 = Frahm (1997) 197; building inscription T.10/11:209-12, 216-62b, 268-74 = Frahm (1997) 78-80, 82f; King viii 16-64, 71-6 = OIP 2 113-16; ICC 38-42, bull no. 2:41-8 = OIP 2 124f (for other bull inscriptions with relevant passages see Russell [1999] 261-82); T.13 vi 22'-39', viii 1'-12', 1'-23', 28'-32" = Frahm (1997) 92-5; Bavian:6-23, 27-34, 54-6 = OIP 2 79-84; Jerwan block inscriptions: OIP 24 20; OIP 24 23. See Bagg (2000) 167-224 for an evaluation of many of these projects.
- 2'. Building projects at Assur:
- a'. The temple of the god Aššur: Sennacherib rebuilt the central sanctuary of the Assyrian state in imitation of the Esagil complex at Babylon after the destruction of the latter city in 689; a new procession road linked it with the Akitu house outside the city: Aššur Temple:8-30 = OIP 2 144-6; KAV 74 = Schroeder (1920); Ass. 16342 = Frahm (1997) 165f; EŠ 6235 = Donbaz - Galter (1985) 7f; well inscription: see Frahm (1997) 166f; *kisallu* inscription = OIP 2 149 (I.18); block inscription = OIP 2 150 (I.19); *samitu* inscription = OIP 2 148 (I.16); *bit-tikāti* inscription = OIP 2 150 (I.20); IM 62197 = Frahm (1997) 169f. For these texts see Frahm (1997) 163-70 T.129-38, with earlier literature.
- b'. The Akitu house outside the city: The second important sanctuary built after the destruction of Babylon in imitation of the cultic topography of this city was the Akitu house of the god Aššur, which was situated outside the western wall of Assur. The planning proved to be difficult — a first building was abandoned and substituted by a new one with a slightly different ground plan: Bit-akitu:22-36, 44-55 = OIP 2 136-8; stela EŠ 7847:10-27 = Donbaz - Galter (1985) 4-7; KAH 2 117 = OIP 2 142 (I.3); KAH 2 118 = OIP 2 142 (I.4); KAH 2 119 = OIP 2 143 (I.5); T.144 = Frahm (1997) 176f; T.145 = Frahm (1997) 177; K 1356:2-33 = Pongratz-Leisten (1994) 207f; SAA 12 86. For these texts see Frahm (1997) 173-7, 222-4, 242, T.139-45, T.184, ZT.1, with earlier literature.
- c'. The temple of Zababa: The construction of this sanctuary, which was probably situated in the

vicinity of the Aššur temple, is recorded on two stone blocks (Galter [1984] 1f). Cf. furthermore SAA 12 48 and 87, and see Frahm (1997) 177f, 240f.

d'. The Old Palace: A building inscription on a badly damaged Sennacherib prism to be published by the author seems to record construction works at the Old Palace at Assur.

e'. The step gate (*mušlālu*) of the Old Palace: KAH 1 45 = OIP 2 151 (I.24); VS 23 134 and 136 = Frahm (1997) 178f T.148-9; VS 23 135 and 137 = Frahm (1997) 179 T.150.

f'. A house for the prince Aššur-nadin-šumi: The construction of this building, whose exact location is unknown, must have taken place before 700 since Aššur-nadin-šumi became king of Babylon in that year: KAH 1 49 = OIP 2 151f (I.27). For the text see Frahm (1997) T.155, with earlier literature.

g'. A house for the prince Aššur-ili-muballissu: The house was situated near to the city wall in the south-eastern part of Assur: KAH 1 44 = OIP 2 151 (I.23); KAH 1 43 = OIP 2 150 (I.22). For these texts see Frahm (1997) 179f T.151-4.

h'. Sennacherib's royal tomb: Sennacherib seems to have built his own tomb during his lifetime. It was presumably situated under the Old Palace, like the other royal tombs at Assur; the inscriptions commemorating its construction (KAH 1 46 = OIP 2 151 [I.25] and KAH 1 47 = OIP 2 151 [I.26], see Frahm [1997] 181f T.157-8) were, however, found widely dispersed, so that it is clear that the tomb was intentionally destroyed at a later date. Whether Sennacherib was actually buried in it after his death is not completely clear; it should be noted that his grandson Assurbanipal offered slaughtered Babylonians as a *kispu* sacrifice not at his tomb but at the place where he was murdered (Prism A iv 70-3 = Borger [1996] 44, 235). According to the late literary text SAA 3 32 r. 22-5, Sennacherib's ghost sojourned in the Netherworld, watched by the Elamite gods Jabru, Humba, and Naprušu.

3'. A building project at Tarbišu: One of the earliest building projects of Sennacherib, which may be linked (though this is not explicitly stated) to the violent death of his father Sargon, was the reconstruction of the temple of the Netherworld god Nergal at Tarbišu. It is commemorated in two cylinder inscriptions from 702(?) which duplicate one another (Suleiman [n.d.] 134-8:62-9) and in some smaller inscriptions: CBI 185 = OIP 2 155 (I.32); IR 7, 8 = OIP 2 155 (I.33); 3R 3, 13 = OIP 2 155 (I.34). For these texts see Frahm (1997) 188-90 T.162-4a.

4'. Building projects at Kalzu: Sennacherib reconstructed the city wall of Kalzu, as can be inferred from two short inscriptions: Frahm (1997) 190 T.165; CBI 184 = OIP 2 155 (I.35). Another short inscription found at Kalzu mentions the "palace of Sennacherib" (CBI 174). See Frahm (1997) 190f.

5'. A building project at Kalhu: An Assurbanipal prism inscription commemorating the construction of the Nabû temple at Kalhu mentions Sennacherib inscriptions found at that spot, thereby implying

that Sennacherib undertook some renovation work on the sanctuary: Prism CKalach x 112-18 = Borger (1996) 165, 254; see also Frahm (1997) 186-8.

6'. A hydraulic building project near Arbail: Near to the head of a canal which directed water to the city of Arbail Sennacherib left an inscription (Laessoe [1951] 29f; cf. Frahm [1997] 159 T.127; Bagg [2000] 225f).

7'. Building operations in other Assyrian cities: Several short Sennacherib inscriptions have allegedly been found at Šibaniba, Tell Yarah, Beisan, and Tulul al-Lak, where building operations of the king must accordingly have taken place. For the relevant literature see Frahm (1997) 191. For possible building work on a temple in the (so far unidentified) city of Šabbu see SAA 12 21 and Frahm (1997) 241f ZT.5.

8'. Building operations at Sur-marrati: When Sennacherib sojourned in Sur-marrati (Samarra) during the Assyrian campaign against Babylonia in 690 he decided, as can be inferred from an inscription (Baltimore:115-21 = Grayson [1963] 94-6), to repopulate and enlarge the city, to rebuild its wall and to plant gardens in the surrounding meadows.

9'. A building project at Babylon: Presumably sometime between 704 and 694, according to several inscribed paving stones from Babylon (RIMB 2 B.6.23.1), Sennacherib restored the processional road of this city.

III. Sennacherib's character: The "characters" of the Late Assyrian kings are largely hidden under a mask of stereotypic qualities attributed to them in the royal inscriptions composed by their "ghost-writers." Nevertheless, it seems justified to claim that some characteristic features of Sennacherib's personality shine out from behind the mask. Sennacherib was clearly a highly innovative ruler who was fond of experiments. He undertook certain military reforms, reorganizing the *kišir šarrūti* (see Dalley - Postgate [1984] 41). He developed new metal-working techniques and participated personally in the planning and realisation of large building projects. Under his supervision, a new "bird's eye perspective" was created for the palace reliefs in the South-West Palace. Sennacherib did not hesitate to revise his own decisions, as can be inferred from the new succession arrangement by which Esarhaddon became crown prince, and he found very different ways during his reign of dealing with his "Babylonian problem." His religious reform instigated after the destruction of Babylon, with its transfer of certain elements of the Babylonian Marduk cult to Aššur, is probably the most remarkable innovation of his reign. Another outstanding feature of Sennacherib's personality was his comparatively "realistic" world view, for which we have several indications. For example, Sennacherib decided to abolish the "fifth leg," still customary under his father Sargon, of the monumental bull colossi which guarded the entrances of his palace, an innovation which gave the sculptures a more "naturalistic" appearance. The same is true for the aforementioned "bird's eye perspective" of the reliefs. And though he tried to present his reign, in his inscriptions, as a "winner's

story," he did not always conceal failures. Thus the return from Elam in 693, caused by the bad weather conditions, is not omitted but freely acknowledged in his annals. Gifted, powerful, and innovative, Sennacherib — and this was the other side of the coin — suffered from a lack of patience when things did not go smoothly. This deficiency may have caused the king to order the radical annihilation of Babylon in 689, an event which, in the long term, proved so fateful for the future relationship between Assyria and Babylonia.

IV. Sennacherib in later tradition: Though never gaining the fame of Nebuchadnezzar or Samsarramat/Semiramis, Sennacherib is one of the very few historical personalities of the ancient Near East who figure prominently in the later traditions of the Arameans (the Ahikar story), of Judaism, Christianity and Islam (with a special focus on the campaign against Jerusalem), and of the classical world. A short, non-comprehensive overview of the relevant literature is given in Frahm (1997) 21-8, where precise references can be found.

V. Attestations of Sennacherib's name (references from royal inscriptions and Assurbanipal colophons are not fully exhaustive; references where the royal name is completely broken away are excluded):

1. In texts from the reign of Sargon II:

a. As sender of letters despatched by him to his father (all undated): ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 1 31:2 // SAA 1 36:2; ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 1 38:2 // SAA 1 35:1; ^{md}30-[PAB-MEŠ-SU] SAA 5 281:2; [^{md}30]-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 1 29:2; [^{md}30]-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 1 33:2; ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 1 32:1.

b. In a letter written to Sargon by Hunnî: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 1 133:9 (not dated).

c. In the colophon of an astrological text written by the scribe of his chief eunuch: ^{md}GAR-PAB.MEŠ-SU-*ba* (so according to the copy; both GAR and SU, which might be *-eri-*, are in need of collation) AAT 44 r 11' = Hunger (1968) 512:4 (not dated, but can be dated to the reign of Sargon because Sennacherib is called "great [crown] prince [lit.: eldest royal son] of Sargon").

d. In an administrative text concerning the construction of Dur-Šarrukīn (context broken): [^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU] SAA 11 17 r. i 5' (not dated or date lost).

2. In Sennacherib's own inscriptions and other texts from his reign:

a. Inscriptions:

1'. In self-predications in the introductory section: ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* First Campaign:1 = OIP 2 48; Tarbišu Cylinders nos. I and II:1 = Suleiman (n.d.) 168; Bellino:1 = OIP 2 55; Rassam:1 = Frahm (1997) 51; King i 1 = CT 26, pl. 1; Bull 4:1 = OIP 2 66; Chicago i 1 = Borger (1979) 68; Taylor i 1 = 1R pl. 37; Jerusalem i 1 = Ling-Israel (1990) 220; Nebi-Yunus:1 = OIP 2 85; OIP 2 152 I.30:1 (and the duplicate 1R 7 F:1); Scott - MacGinnis (1990) 73 and Pl. Xb (ii):1 (read from the photograph); 3R 3 13:1 = OIP 2 155 I.34 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 189 T.164); Ahmad - Grayson (1999) 187:1. [^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU/*eri-ba*] 89-4-26,170:1 (cf. Frahm [1997] 108f

T.20); K 2661:1 (cf. Frahm [1997] 195-9 T.170). [^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*] A 16929 i 1 (cf. Frahm [1997] 71). [^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*] 79-7-8,307 i 1 (cf. Frahm [1997] 103). ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU ICC 38:1 = OIP 2 117; CBI 185 BM 90219:2. [^{md}EN.ZU-PAB.MEŠ-SU BM 128242:1 = Iraq 7 94 (cf. Frahm [1997] 111 T.24). ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* ICC 61:1. ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Bulls 1-3:1 = OIP 2 76; Room V, Slab 11:1 = Russell (1999) 285; Court VI, slab 60:1 = Russell (1999) 286; Court VI, slab 66 (and 68):1 = Frahm (1997) 126 T.48; Room XXXVI, Slab 12, in front of enthroned king:1 = Russell (1999) 287; Room XXXVI, Slab 12, over the tent:1 = Russell (1999) 288; Hall XLIX, epigraph no. 1:1 = Russell (1999) 290; Hall XLIX, epigraph no. 2:1 = Russell (1999) 290; Room LXX, slab 4:1 = Russell (1999) 291; Room I, threshold:1 = Russell (1991) 269; CBI 172:1; CBI 173:1; CBI 174:1 (var.: ^{md}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*, [^{md}30]-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU); CBI 176:1; CBI 177:1; CBI 178:1; CBI 180:1; CBI 181:1; CBI 182:1; CBI 183:1; "Palace inscription":1 = Russell (1991) 271 (for some duplicates see Frahm [1997] 140); Back of Winged Lions:1 = Russell (1991) 276; Meissner - Rost (1893) Tf. 11, 82-2-4,1:1 and 82-2-4,2:1; Frahm (1997) 142 T.80a:1; Galter (1987) no. 43:1 (and, partly broken, nos. 45:1; 46:1; 48:1; 51:1; 53:1; 54:1; 55:1; 56:1; 58:1; 60:1; 61:1; 63:1; 66:1; 68:1; 69:1; 70:1; 72:1; 74:1; 76:1); MacGinnis (1989) 189:1; 83-1-18,701:1 (door socket inscription); 83-1-18,705:1 (door socket inscription); BM 93088:1 = Walker (1980) 84f; OIP 2 63 E.3:6; Jerwan A:1 = OIP 24 19; Jerwan B:1 = OIP 24 20; Safar (1946) 51:1; KAH 2 124:1 = OIP 2 144; KAH 1 73:1 = OIP 2 149 I.18 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 167 T.134); KAH 1 74:1 = OIP 2 150 I.19 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 168 T.135); KAH 1 72:1 = OIP 2 150 I.20 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 168f T.137); KAH 2 122:1 = OIP 2 135; KAH 2 117:1 = OIP 2 142 I.3 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 175 T.141); KAH 2 118:1 = OIP 2 142 I.4 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 176 T.142); KAH 2 119:1 = OIP 2 143 I.5; Ass. 11046a-i:1 = Frahm (1997) 177 T.145; KAH 1 45:1 = OIP 2 151 I.24; Ass. 1058:1 = Frahm (1997) 178 T.148; Ass. 1270:1 = Frahm (1997) 179 T.150; KAH 1 43:1 = OIP 2 150 I.22 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 179f T.152-4); KAH 1 44:1 = OIP 2 151 I.23; KAH 1 49:1 = OIP 2 151f I.27; VS 23 157:1 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 180f T.156); KAH 1 46:4 = OIP 2 151 I.25 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 181f T.157); KAH 1 47:4 = OIP 2 151 I.26 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 182 T.158); Watanabe (1985) 380:11; Watanabe (1985) 386:5; 1R 7 nVIII D:1 = OIP 2 155 I.33 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 189 T.163); CBI 184:1; K 1280:1 = OIP 2 156 I.36; Baltimore:3 = Grayson (1963) 83; Sm 1893:3 = Frahm (1997) 219 T.181; Sm 1893 r. 1 = Frahm (1997) 219 T.181; K 1356:1 = Pongratz-Leisten (1994) 207f; stone slab BM 139997:1; [^{md}30-PAB].MEŠ-SU Room V, Slab 30:1 = Russell (1999) 285. [^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Room V, Slab 41:1 = Russell (1999) 285. ^{md}30-[PAB.MEŠ-SU] Room X, Slab 7:1 = Russell (1999) 287. ^{md}30-PAB.[MEŠ-SU] epigraph in unknown room:1 = Russell (1999) 292. ^{md}30-

PAB.MEŠ-[S]U ICC 75 A:1. [^m]^d30-PAB.MEŠ-[SU] CBI 179:1. [^m]^d30¹-PAB.MEŠ-SU Frahm (1997) T.168. ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-(SU) Nassouhi (1927) 19 no. IX:1. ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba* CBI 175:1 (var.: ^md30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba*); Frahm (1997) 190 T.165:1; K 6109:1 = Borger (1988) 11. ^m30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Ass. 17182:1 = Galter (1984) 1. ^m30-PAB.ME[Š-SU] Ass. 3999a:1 = Galter (1984) 1; KAH 1 43, Ass. 366:1; KAH 1 48:1 = OIP 2 148 I.16 (for duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 168 T.136). [^m]^d30-P[AB.MEŠ-SU] AAA 18 no. 16:17 = Frahm (1998b) 109. ^d30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Frahm (1997) 176 T.144:1. [^d]¹30-PAB.MEŠ-[SU] RIMB 2 B.6.23.1:1. ^md30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Bavian:3 = OIP 2 78. ^md30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* CBI 185:2 (for further duplicates cf. Frahm [1997] 188 T.162). ^md30-[ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-SU/*eri-ba*] K 2662 r. 24' = Frahm (1997) 198; stone slab Ass 2227:1. [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-SU K 5313a:6 = OIP 2 149 I.17. [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU K 15231:6' = Frahm (1997) 236 (not necessarily a Sennacherib text). [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-SU Ass. 2235:1 = Frahm (1997) 178 T.149; Ass. 19531:1 = Frahm (1997) 179 T.150. [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ/PAB.ME[Š-SU] *eri-ba* Sm 2083 i 1 (cf. Frahm [1997] 70); ICC 75 B:1 = Russell (1999) 292. [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba* EŠ 7847:1 = Galter (1985) 5. [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba* K 7981:1 = Frahm (1997) 214 T.178. [^m]^d30-PAB.ME[Š-SU/*eri-ba*] Frahm (1997) 166f T.133:1(?). [^m]^d30-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-SU K 20599:1 (cf. Frahm [1997] 108f T.20).

2'. Other occasions: Named in a passage about a report on military matters given to him: ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* First Campaign:16 = OIP 2 50. ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* Tarbišu Cylinders nos. I-II:16 = Suleiman (n.d.) 161.

In the place name "Kar-Sin-ahhe-eriba," intended to replace the name of the city of Elenzash: ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* Bellino:32 = OIP 2 32; Rassam:29 = Frahm (1997) 53; King ii 45 = CT 26, pl. 6; Heidel ii 46 = Sumer 9 128. ^dEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* Bull 4:16 = OIP 2 68. ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Chicago ii 29 = Borger (1979) 72. ^dEN-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU (sic, scribal mistake) Tayl. ii 26 = IR 38. ^dEN.ZU-[ŠEŠ].MEŠ-[SU/*eri-ba*] Jerusalem ii 27 = Ling-Israel (1990) 225. [^m]^dEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-[SU/*eri-ba*] K 2627+:12' (cf. Frahm [1997] 199-201 T.171). ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-[SU/*eri-ba*] Rm 2, 98 i' 3' (cf. Frahm [1997] 109). ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU/*eri-ba* K 1665 ii 1' (cf. Frahm [1997] 106); 81-7-27,9 ii 11' (cf. Frahm [1997] 70).

Named in a passage concerning his idea of starting a great building program at Nineveh: ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* First Campaign:70; Bellino:41 = OIP 2 95; Rassam:68 = Frahm (1997) 55 (var.: ^mdEN.ZU-PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba*); T.10/11:22 = Frahm (1997) 72 (var.: ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU); King v 48 = OIP 2 103; Heidel v 77 = Sumer 9 152.

In the name of the "Sennacherib Gate" of Nineveh: ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* T.10/11:171 = Frahm (1997) 77; King vii 76 = OIP 2 112; Heidel vii 80 = Sumer 9 168. ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU T.13 vii 16' = Frahm (1997) 93.

In the name of the Mullissu Gate of Nineveh, called "May the rule of Sennacherib be as firm as the station of Ursa Maior": ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* King vii 78 = OIP 2 112; Heidel vii 82 = Sumer

9 168; ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU T.13 vii 18' = Frahm (1997) 93.

In the watercourse name "Sennacherib channel" (*patti Sin-ahhē-eriba*): ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Bavian:12 = OIP 2 79.

In the watercourse name "Sennacherib river" (*nār Sin-ahhē-eriba*): ^md30-ŠEŠ (var.: PAB).MEŠ-SU Bavian:15 = OIP 2 80 (cf. Frahm [1997] 153).

Named in a passage about his hydraulic activities: ^md30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Bavian: 18 = OIP 2 80.

Mentioned in an exclamation attributed to fearful Elamites who expect an Assyrian attack: ^md30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Bavian:40 = OIP 2 82.

Mentioned in a passage referring to an image of the king: ^d30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU K 6177+:10 = George (1986) 134. ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU K 1356:26 = Pon-gratz-Leisten (1994) 207f.

Named in passages invoking divine blessings for the king: [^d]¹30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU K 6177+:17 = George (1986) 134. ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU K 2411 ii 11' = Streck (1916) 294f.

In a passage asking the foundation inscription to invoke divine blessings for the king: ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU OIP 2 147 I.8:20; A 16931:6' = Frahm (1997) 110; KAH 2 122:56 = OIP 2 138. ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-[SU] KAH 2 124:30 = OIP 2 146.

b. In the succession treaty for Esarhaddon: [^md30-PAB.M]EŠ-[SU] // ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 2 3:1', 3' (not dated or date lost).

c. In grants and donations:

1'. Sennacherib Land Grants: [^md30]-[PAB/ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU/*eri-ba*] SAA 12 20:1 (date lost) // SAA 12 21:1 (date lost).

2'. Dedication of personnel for the newly-built Akitu House: ^mdEN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* SAA 12 86:2 (dated 22nd year of Sennacherib, i.e. 684?).

3'. Gift of Sennacherib for Esarhaddon: ^mdEN.(ZU)-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* SAA 12 88:1 (not dated).

d. In inscriptions of his wives:

1'. Tašmetu-šarrat: In her title of a royal wife as given in a label inscription on two vessels: ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU KAH 1 50 = OIP 2 152 I.28 (see Frahm [1997] 184 for a duplicate).

2'. Naqī'a: In her title of a royal wife as given in a building inscription: [^m]^d30/EN.ZU-PAB/ŠEŠ.MEŠ-[SU] 91-5-9,217:3' = Borger (1988) 11. In her title of a royal wife as given in dedication inscriptions: ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU ADD 645 r. 3 (not dated). ^m30-P[AB.MEŠ-SU] Galter (1987) no. 44:1 (not dated).

3'. Name so far undeciphered (possibly not a royal wife): On a stele from Assur, in the title of a woman(?) somehow related to the king: ^d30-PAB.ME[Š-S]U Andrae (1913) 10:4.

e. In the operative section of legal documents: ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU (in the title of his chariot driver Nabû-šumu-iškun) SAA 6 57:7' (date lost); ^md30-PAB.ME[Š-SU] (in the title of Marduk[...], the king's [...]) SAA 6 59:7 (684); [^m]^d30-PAB.MEŠ-SU (in the title of the king's daughter Šadditu) SAA 6 251:5' (date lost).

f. In the date formulae of legal documents, royal inscriptions, and colophons of literary texts:

1'. As eponym for the year 687: ^md30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 6 158 r. 8; SAA 6 88 r. 12'; SAA 6 154 l.e. 3; ND 2306 r. 21; ^m30-PAB.MEŠ-SU StAT 2 67 r. 2;

Stat 2 278 t.e. 7; SAA 6 156 r. 7; SAA 6 152 b.e. 9'; SAA 6 160 r. 15; O 3680 r. 17; ^{m30}-PAB-SU (sic) BT 105 r. 2; [^{m30}]-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Stat 2 103 r. 3; ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-[SU] SAA 6 157 t.e. 10; ^{m30}[30-PAB.MEŠ-SU] SAA 6 151 t.e. 11; ^{m30}[0-PAB.MEŠ-SU] SAA 6 159 r. 4'; ^{m30}[30-PAB.MEŠ-SU] SAA 6 153 r. 4'.

2'. In dates counted by regnal years, especially in "double datings" (i.e. with both eponym and regnal year): [^{m30}]-EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* CT 30 pl. 25, K 3068 r. 5' = Hunger (1968) 294(B) (704, regnal year lost); ^{m30}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* (sic.) Borger (1973) 171 A r. ii "47" = Hunger (1968) 501:6 (700, 6th regnal year); ^{m30}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-*eri-ba*/SU] ACh 2. Spl. 77, K 398 r. 6 = Hunger (1968) 293(P) (698, 7th regnal year); ^{m30}EN.ZU-PAB/ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU-*ba* (writing uncertain; *SU-ba* in need of collation) 3R 2, 20, K 75+ r 25 = Hunger (1968) 305:4 (694, 11th regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU AFO 20 83:126 (690, 14th regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 6 174 t.e. 16 (685, 21st regnal year); 3R 2, 22; K 2670 r. 12' = Hunger (1968) 299:9 (684, 22nd regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 6 177 r. 19 (684, 22nd regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 12 86 r. 33 (no eponym date, 22nd regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 6 180 r. 2 (eponym date lost, 22nd regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 6 90 r. 16 (eponym date lost, 23rd regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.M[ŠEŠ-SU] SAA 6 48 l.e. 1 (eponym date lost?, 24th regnal year); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU O 3703 r. 12 (no eponym date, 25th regnal year); ^{m30}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* AAT 78b r 8' = Hunger (1968) 293 (O) (eponym date lost, regnal year lost).

3'. Referring to the "time" of Sennacherib (*ina tarši Sin-ahhē-eriba*): ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-KU₄ STT 192 r. 26' = Hunger (1968) 353:3 (701); ^{m30}-PAB.[MEŠ]-KU₄ STT 33 127 = Hunger (1968) 351:6 (701).

g. In administrative texts, referring to officials who form the "new corps" of the king: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 7 3 i 6' (16-x., no year date); ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 7 4 i 8' (not dated or date lost, but see Mattila [2000] 17).

3. Mentioned in inscriptions of Esarhaddon, Assurbanipal and Šamaš-šumu-ukin, and in other texts from their reigns:

a. In inscriptions of Esarhaddon:

1'. In the genealogy: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU (some references slightly damaged) Borger (1956) AssA i 5 (exact writing uncertain); AssB:15; AssD:1; AssG:4 (var.: ^{m30}); KlchC:3; KlchD:6 (var.: ^{m30}); NinA ii 14; NinB i 3 (see Borger [1956] 125); NinG:4; NinK:3 (exact writing uncertain); NinL:3; NinM:2 (var.: PAB.ME); AsBbA:47 (reading uncertain, possibly ME instead of MEŠ); MnmA r. 15; MnmC:6; RIMB 2 B.6.31.16:10 // 18:9; ZA 2 299f no. 3 (BM 22465):5; CTN 3 26:3; CTN 3 82:3' (possibly a copy or draft of a royal inscription). ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU (some references slightly damaged) Borger (1956) AssE; AssF:2 (var.: PAB-ME). ^{m30}-PAB.ME-SU RIMB 2 B.6.31.13:8. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ⁷¹.MEŠ-SU RIMB 2 B.6.31.19:7. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ⁷¹.ME[Š-SU/eri-ba] RIMB 2 B.6.31.21:6. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Borger (1956) NinH-I:8 (see Borger [1996] 135); RIMB 2 B.6.31.11:13; RIMB 2 B.6.31.17:10.

^{m30}-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* RIMB 2 B.6.31.15:26. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ.ME[Š-SU/eri-ba] (in archaising script) Borger (1956) 117 K 7943. ^{m30}-[ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-SU/eri-ba] Borger (1956) NinR. ^{m30}EN.ZU-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* Borger (1956) KlchA:37. [^{m30}]-EN¹.ZU-ŠEŠ-*eri-ba* Borger (1956) TrbA:20 (probably a scribal mistake). ^{m30}-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-[SU/eri-ba] BM 56617 i 8' = Iraq 55 122.

2'. Other references: Referring to Sennacherib's conquest of Adummatu: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Borger (1956) NinA iv 2; NinB ii 47.

Referring to Sennacherib's activities(?) in favour of Haldi(?) of Mušair: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Borger (1956) Smlt r. 45.

b. In inscriptions of Assurbanipal:

1'. In the genealogy: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism B i 5 // C i 5 // T i 7 = Borger (1996) 92, 205; Prism J, Stück 1:12 = Borger (1996) 194, 209; IIT:17 = Borger (1996) 266; L4 i 2' = Streck (1916) 252f; RIMB 2 B.6.32.4:7; RIMB 2 B.6.32.5:7. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU RIMB 2 B.6.32.1:9; RIMB 2 B.6.32.6:6; RIMB 2 B.6.32.12:7; RIMB 2 B.6.32.19:16; RIMB 2 B.6.32.22:6. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ.ME[Š]-S[U] RIMB 2 B.6.32.14:22. [^{m30}]-[^{m30}]-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU¹ RIMB 2 B.6.32.15:9. ^{m30}-[ŠEŠ⁷¹.MEŠ-SU] RIMB 2 B.6.32.2:33. ^{m30}-PAB.[MEŠ-SU/eri-ba] LET 2' = Onasch (1994) II 54.

2'. Other references: Referring to Sennacherib's conquest of Bit Imbi: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism A iv 126 = Borger (1996) 46, 237f.

Referring to Sennacherib's defeat of the Elamites in the battle of Halulē: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism C ix 56' = Borger (1996) 161, 236.

Referring to Sennacherib's work on the *bēt re-dūti* at Nineveh: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism A i 25 // F i 19 = Borger (1996) 16, 208; Prism A x 53 // F vi 24 = Borger (1996) 72, 255.

Referring to Sennacherib's work on the *ekal māšarte* at Nineveh: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism B viii 65 = Borger (1996) 117, 252; Prism B viii 86 = Borger (1996) 117, 252.

Referring to Sennacherib's work on the wall of the inner city of Nineveh: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism D viii 65 = Borger (1996) 118, 252; Prism D viii 87 = Borger (1996) 119, 253. ^{m30}-PAB.[MEŠ-SU/eri-ba] Prism E, Stück 18:5 = Borger (1996) 183, 251.

Referring to an inscription of Sennacherib found at the Nabû temple at Kalhu: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism CKalach x 114 = Borger (1996) 165, 254.

Referring to sacrifices at the place where Sennacherib was killed: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU Prism A iv 71 = Borger (1996) 44, 235.

c. In inscriptions of Šamaš-šumu-ukin (in the genealogy): ^{m30}-PAB.ME-SU RIMB 2 B.6.33.3:10. ^{m30}-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU RIMB 2 B.6.33.4:21 // 6:7'.

d. In treaties:

1'. Vassal treaties of Esarhaddon (in the royal genealogy): ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 2 6:2 (672).

2'. Zakutu treaty (in Zakutu's title of a royal wife): ^{m30}-P[AB¹.MEŠ-SU] SAA 2 8:1 (not dated).

e. In the royal genealogy of grants and donations:

1'. Esarhaddon: ^{m30}-PAB.MEŠ-[s]U SAA 12 24:5 (not dated).

2'. Assurbanipal: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 12 29:3 (not dated or date lost).

f. In the royal genealogy of colophons on texts from the Assurbanipal libraries: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Hunger (1968) 318:3 ("Asb. Typ b"); CT 18 37, K 4323 r. ii 14' = Hunger (1968) 327:4 ("Asb. Typ n"); Hunger (1968) 328:8 ("Asb. Typ o"); BA 5 669, K 5118 r. 2 = Hunger (1968) 334:2 ("Asb. Typ v"); Langdon, BL, pl. 16, Sm 794 r. 7' = Hunger (1968) 335:4; OECT 6 pl. XIII r. 16' = Hunger (1968) 340:1. ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* Delitzsch (1885) 136, Sm 954 r. 31 = Hunger (1968) 322:4. ^{md}30/EN.ZU-PAB/ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* (exact writing uncertain) Rm 2, 126: 29 = Hunger (1968) 333:5 ("Asb. Typ u").

g. In letters (all undated): ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU ABL 442 r. 2; ABL 1217+ r. 5'; ^m30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 10 96 r. 7, 19, i.e. 1; ^d30-PAB.MEŠ-SU ABL 454:7; ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU ABL 1365:9, 11; ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU CT 54 60:18'; [^{md}30]-PAB.MEŠ-ŠU' (reading very uncertain) CT 54 107 r. 4'; [^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU CT 54 554 r. 11'; [*sn*]hrb Hug (1993) 19-21 AssB:16 (Aramaic ostrakon from Assur).

h. In a Babylonian text dealing with actions directed against Esarhaddon after Sennacherib's death: ^d30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* AfO 17 7f. 6, 8 (not dated); a conspirator is claiming that the army of Esarhaddon is much weaker than Sennacherib's army.

i. In legal documents:

1'. In a passage accusing a certain Aḫu-eriba of having intended to give his son the king's name: ^{md}30-PAB.M[ŠEŠ]-SU SAAB 1 68 b.e. 12 (not dated).

2'. In the name of the provincial center Dur-Sin-aḫhe-eriba (*eššū*), presumably a new name for the city of Alihi: ^{md}30-PAB.[MEŠ-SU] SAA 14 10 r. 8' (667); Ass. 11628a, see AfO 13 315f and AfO 17 303 (639) (writing uncertain, no exact transliteration published).

j. In a literary letter to Assurbanipal from his son, referring to Assurbanipal's descent: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU SAA 3 25 r. i 2' (not dated or date lost).

k. In the introductory passage of the "Sin of Sargon," a text stylized as a Sennacherib inscription but probably written in the reign of Esarhaddon: [^{md}30-PAB/ŠEŠ-M]EŠ-ŠU' K 4730+ 1'; see Tadmor *et al.* (1989) for an edition and discussion of the text.

4. Mentioned in inscriptions of Sin-šarru-iškun:

a. In the the genealogy: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU RIMS 1 57:3; KAH 2 134:6 (var.: ^m30-PAB.MEŠ-SU, ^{md}30-PAB-SU). ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU (var.: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU) Sši Cyl A:14. [^{md}30]-PAB.MEŠ-SU KAH 1 56:4. ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU KAH 2 130 ii 5. [^{md}30]-PAB.MEŠ-SU KAV 171 r. 4.

b. In a passage referring to Sennacherib's construction of an "alabaster house" on Kuyunjik and the inscription he left there: [^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Sši Cyl C 13'. ^{md}30-[PAB.MEŠ-SU] Sši Cyl C 18'.

5. Mentioned in Assyrian "cultic" texts: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU CA pl. 1f r. iv 5' = Menzel (1981) II T.65 (mentions the eponym Šamaš-da'inanni, therefore to be dated to 645* or later); CA pl. 1f r. iv 24' = Menzel (1981) II T.65 (mentions the eponym Šamaš-da'inanni, therefore to be dated to

645* or later); STT 88 r. ii 4' = Menzel (1981) II T.133 (not dated). ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-ŠU' STT 88 v 12' = Menzel (1981) II T.133 (not dated). ^m30-[PAB.MEŠ-SU] (reading uncertain) PKTA 39f r. i 1' = Menzel (1981) II T.18f (not dated).

6. Mentioned in king lists, eponym lists, and eponym chronicles:

a. In king lists: ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Babylonian King List A iv 12', 19' = Grayson (1980) 93; Synchronistic King List iv 1 (damaged), 7, 10, 12 (in the filiation of Esarhaddon) = Grayson (1980) 120 (mentioned with his personal scholars Nabû-aplu-iddina, Bel-upahhir, and Kalbu). ^{md}30-PA[B.MEŠ-SU] Synchronistic King List Fragment KAV 9 iv 4' = Grayson (1980) 122.

b. In an Assyrian Eponym Chronicle, referring to the king's accession: ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Eponym Chronicle 705 (B6 r. 11) = Millard (1994) 48.

c. In the Assyrian Eponym List:

1'. Referring to the beginning of the king's rule: [^{md}30-PAB/ŠEŠ-M]EŠ-SU Eponym List 704 (A4 ii 15) = Millard (1994) 49.

2'. Referring to the king holding the office of Eponym in 687: [^m30-PAB.MEŠ-SU // ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU // ^{md}30-PAB.MEŠ-SU Eponym List 687 (A1 v 37, A5 iii 5', A7 ix 6) = Millard (1994) 51.

7. Mentioned in Babylonian chronicles: ^d30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU Babylonian Chronicle ii 24, 26, 30, 36; iii 9, 34, 35 = Grayson (1975) 77-81. ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-*eri-ba* Esarhaddon Chronicle:31 = Grayson (1975) 127. ^{md}30-ŠEŠ/PAB.MEŠ-SU/*eri-ba* Akitu Chronicle:1 = Grayson (1975) 131.

8. Mentioned in an inscription of Nabonidus, referring to the destruction of the temple of the goddess Anunitu at Sippar instigated by him: ^{md}30-ŠEŠ.MEŠ-SU CT 34 pl. 34 iii 28. E. Frahm